

DOING OR LEADING

Executing is not wrong.

When the leader should get hands on.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

What is wrong is executing out of exhaustion, anxiety or distrust, and calling it an example.

THE CASCADE

The cycle of doing it all alongside.



WHAT YOU SEE

You step in to help with a tight delivery...



THE MECHANISM

...it repeats, and becomes the team's default expectation...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and leadership vanishes, because no time is left for it.

Executing pays out immediately. Leading only shows up weeks later.

THE FORK

Before you step in, check the reason.

CHECK THE REASON

01



No time to hand it to anyone? Step in.

02



You stepped in because the deadline made you anxious? Do not.

03



You stepped in because nobody does it like you? Sit down and teach.

If the reason is not on the list of four, you are escaping from leading.

THE METHOD

The four legitimate reasons.

01 **REAL EMERGENCY**

the deadline is now and there is no time to transfer it

02 **TEACHING BY DOING**

someone has to see how it is done, with you narrating why

03 **SETTING THE CULTURE**

the gesture communicates a standard no speech would

04 **THE CALL ONLY YOU MAKE**

the risk is yours, and transferring it would pass the bill on

Outside those four, every hour executing is an hour of leadership not exercised.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Four reasons that look legitimate and are not.

01 • REAL
EMERGENCY

It is faster if I do it.

faster today, and you will repeat that until December

02 • TEACHING
BY DOING

Nobody does it to my standard.

either the standard was never explained, or it is your preference

03 • SETTING
THE CULTURE

I want to show I am in this with them.

being in it is removing blockers, not doing someone else's task

04 • THE CALL
ONLY YOU MAKE

I get anxious watching it go slowly.

your anxiety is not the team's problem, it is yours to manage

TWO MODELS

Stepping in to rescue or to raise.

THE COMMON MODEL

To rescue

Takes the task and delivers it alone

The team watches and waits

Solves today's case

Repeats it next month

THE DESIGNED MODEL

To raise

Does it together, narrating the why

Someone else runs the next one

Solves the case and the gap

Does not have to repeat it

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three things that vanish when you execute too much.

01 The medium term direction.

→ nobody on the team can do this in your place.

02 The development of people.

→ whoever is executing is not building anyone up.

03 The removal of blockers only you can remove.

→ the highest leverage work, and the first to be sacrificed.

| Everyone on the team can execute. Only you can do those three.

THE CHAIN

The third hand test.

01

Did you do the same thing for the team three times this month?



02

Then it was not an emergency, it was a pattern.



03

Something is missing, a process or a person, and neither is fixed by your hands.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

While you patch the hole, nobody in the company sees that it exists.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

How to decide next time.



STEP 01

**Before stepping in,
write the reason in
one line.**

if it does not fit the four
legitimate ones, do not
step in



STEP 02

**If you do step in,
bring someone to do
it with you.**

a manager executing
should always be
building someone up



STEP 03

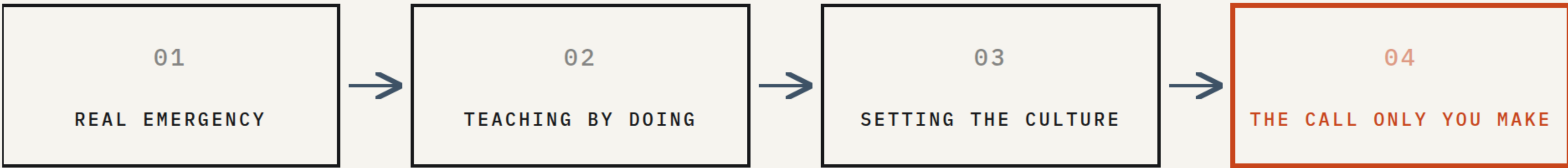
**Log what was missing
for the team to do it
alone.**

that list becomes your
process plan or your
hiring plan

Every time you execute alone, a gap stays invisible for another month.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Four Legitimate Reasons, in the order that matters.



Hands on by choice is leadership. By habit it is a bottleneck.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
next time you feel the urge to do it yourself.

FABIO GARCIA
MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA